



Ebook Readers

Quite early in the year, in our February issue, we pitted several ebook readers against each other. Our verdict was clear. Amazon's Kindle 3 was the winner on all fronts. The factors that went against the Kindle 3 was the overall cost considering Amazon's international shipping charges. Over the months, several factors began stacking up in favour of the Kindle. A couple of companies discontinued their ebook reader businesses. Amazon, on the other hand, continued business as usual waiving off shipping charges. It also added 5 GB of cloud storage space free with your Kindle account.

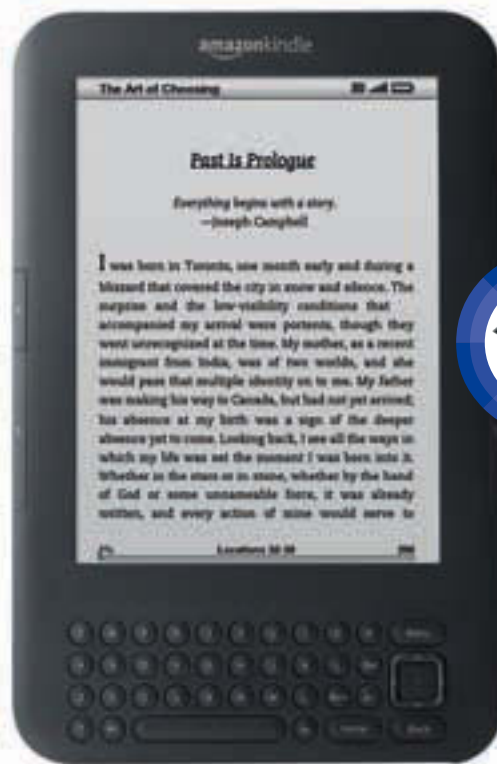
The Indian market for products is unique in many ways. It is large and growing, and among the fastest in the world. Yet, in several categories, ebook readers in particular, many exciting options aren't available. Thankfully, Amazon ships to India. Speaking of Indian products there's the Infibeam Pi (and recently Pi2) that provide excellent value for money. Products such as the Leaf ebook reader and Wink reader don't exist any more. Hence, Kindle 3 is our winner, followed by the Infibeam Pi2 and the Pi.

It's easy to get lost in the several products we've heard of. Yes, the Kindle has an edge, but it stands true to its merit as well. The basis for owning an ebook reader is simple. You like reading. But then, any device with a display should serve the purpose. There would be nothing special in a technology called e-ink display. This, also happens to be the USP of this product category. LCD displays have a reflective surface and with the need of a backlight, simply can't be read in daylight. You'd be better off with a laptop or a netbook then. That's a strict no! So the device should be as close to paper as possible. Of course, we can't get the touch, feel and smell of paper so we'll do without that for now.

The weight of the device is important as well. As hard as you'd find to believe us, a 500-gram device feels like a ton when you're reading a novel. Considering that it's an electronic device, it needs batteries, and with that recharges. The longer each charge powers the device, the better. That eventually determines how long a trip you'll have company in your hands.

Zero1 Winner Kindle 3

The Kindle 3 that we tested is now known as the Kindle Keyboard with 3G. There are five Kindle



Kindle 3
Price: ₹7,367 (\$139)

devices currently available in the Amazon Kindle store. These include the Kindle Touch, Kindle Touch 3G and a budget version at \$79 (₹4,127). However, considering that there's a touch-enabled device in the offing too, we recommend against it, for now.

Worthy Mentions Infibeam Pi2

The Infibeam Pi2 is an option you may consider, especially if you prefer reading vernacular languages over English. You should know that our test centre found the response sluggish. The Infibeam Pi2 seems over-priced, especially when compared to the Kindle. Nevertheless, the fact that Infibeam has a base in India, may go in favour of it. As mentioned earlier, we don't recommend touch-based devices for reading due to the glare they introduce.

Infibeam Pi

The Infibeam Pi was our Editor's Pick during the tests. Considering that the Infibeam Pi2 with Touch, extra storage space and a better build quality sells at ₹9,999, it's a reason to wonder why Infibeam hasn't reduced the prices for the Pi. If you want a no-nonsense ebook reader, this might be the one for you. But then again, it seems too pricey!



Infibeam Pi2
Price: ₹9,999



Infibeam Pi
Price: ₹9,999